

Mattau Health

Community member

Health information for every village in Papua New Guinea.

More topics

- Safe Motherhood
- TB
- AIDS
- Healthy Village
- Malaria
- Farming

This site gives general health information. If you or someone in your family is sick, go to your nearest health centre or talk to your village health worker.

Safe Motherhood

A healthy pregnancy and a safe birth protect both the mother and the baby. Start care early and plan ahead.

For community members

Key messages

- Go to the health centre as soon as you know you are pregnant, and keep going for check-ups.
- Plan where you will give birth and how you will get there before labour starts. Talk to your husband, family and village leaders about transport.
- Eat a variety of foods, drink clean water, and rest.
- Sleep under a bed net every night.
- After the birth, bring your baby for check-ups and immunisation. Breastfeed your baby.

Go to the health centre or hospital straight away if you have

- Heavy bleeding
- A very bad headache, blurred vision, or fits
- Fever or bad-smelling fluid
- The baby moving much less, or not at all
- Waters have broken but labour has not started
- Labour that goes on for a long time

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.

TB

TB is a sickness of the lungs. It spreads through the air when a person with TB coughs. TB can be cured if you finish all of your medicine.

For community members

Key messages

- A cough that lasts two weeks or more is a reason to be tested.
- Go to the health centre for a test. Do not wait.
- Take your medicine every day until the health worker says you are finished. This usually takes about six months. Stopping early can make the TB come back and harder to treat.
- Cover your mouth when you cough and keep rooms airy.
- People living with someone who has TB should be checked, especially children.

Get tested if you have

- A cough for two weeks or more
- Coughing up blood
- Night sweats or fever
- Losing weight without trying
- Feeling very tired

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.

AIDS

HIV is a virus that weakens the body's defences. AIDS is the late stage if HIV is not treated. With treatment, people with HIV can stay healthy for many years.

For community members

Key messages

- HIV spreads through unprotected sex, through blood (shared needles, razors or unsafe blood), and from a mother to her baby during pregnancy, birth or breastfeeding.
- HIV does not spread by hugging, sharing food or plates, using the same toilet, or mosquito bites.
- You can get tested at the health centre. Knowing your status lets you protect yourself and your family.
- Treatment is available. Taking it every day keeps the virus under control.

- A pregnant woman who is tested and takes treatment can protect her baby.
- Using condoms and staying with one faithful, tested partner lowers the risk. Never share needles or razors.
- Do not shame or shut out people with HIV. Support them to stay on treatment.

Think about getting tested if

- You have had sex without a condom or with more than one partner
- You have TB
- You are pregnant
- Your partner has tested positive
- You have had a long fever, diarrhoea or weight loss with no clear reason

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.

Healthy Village

A healthy village is one where people plan together, keep their water clean, and look after each other.

For community members

Key messages

- Hold regular village meetings about health and agree on actions together.
- Protect your water source. Keep it clean and covered, and keep animals away.
- Build and use toilets, and keep the village clear of rubbish.
- Support your village health worker, and take sick people to the health centre early.
- Look after the old, the sick and people with disabilities.

Tell your village health worker or leader if

- Many people become sick at the same time
- The village water source is dirty or has dried up
- A mother or child needs help getting to the health centre

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.

Malaria

Malaria spreads through mosquito bites. It is dangerous, especially for babies, young children and pregnant women.

For community members

Key messages

- Sleep under a bed net every night.
- If you have a fever, get a test at the health centre or from your village health worker. Do not guess.
- If the test shows malaria, take the full course of medicine.
- Empty standing water around your house and clear long grass, where mosquitoes breed.
- Pregnant women and young children with fever must be seen quickly.

Go to the health centre now if there is

- Fever that will not go away or keeps coming back
- Fits or confusion
- Being very sleepy or hard to wake
- Vomiting again and again, or cannot drink
- Very pale skin or yellow eyes
- Fast or difficult breathing

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.

Farming

Good food from your own garden helps children grow strong and helps everyone fight sickness.

For community members

Key messages

- Plant a mix: a staple like kaukau, taro, banana or cassava; green leafy vegetables; beans and peanuts; and fruit.
- Young children need staples, greens and some protein such as beans, fish, eggs or meat.
- Breastfeed your baby for the first six months with nothing else, then add soft foods and keep breastfeeding.
- Wash hands before preparing food, and keep drinking water covered.
- Sell extra produce to help pay for school fees, medicine and transport.
- Take children under five to be weighed at the health centre or at nutrition outreach

patrols.

Take your child to the health centre if they

- Are very thin or have swollen feet
- Are not growing or gaining weight
- Have no energy and do not want to eat
- Have diarrhoea that does not stop

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.